



New growth

Plants use sugar and starch as fuel. The fuel is transported to cells where it is burned to release energy, which is used to grow new cells and repair old ones.



Wilting leaves

On warm, sunny days, plants lose a lot of water from their leaves. If they lose too much, their leaves collapse. This is called wilting. If plants don't get enough water, their leaves will shrivel and die.

The fruit acts as a store of sugar and water.



Carrot plants store food in their roots.



Desert plants

Plants that live in dry areas such as deserts have to save their water. Many have leaves that are thick and covered in wax to stop transpiration. Cacti have spines rather than leaves and thick stems in which they can store water.



Storing food

Spare food is stored for future use. Plants such as hyacinths store food in the base of their leaves. This makes the leaves swell and form a bulb. The bulb survives the winter and in spring it sprouts new leaves.

weird or what?

The sea slug *Elysia chlorotica* uses photosynthesis. The slug eats algae that it doesn't fully digest. The remains in its system continue to photosynthesize the food and provide energy.